

ARCHITECTURE / ROBERT CAMPBELL

Boston 'exports' are big winners

Awards these days are a dime a dozen, but the "Boston Exports" program still makes sense.

This program gives prizes to Boston architects for work they've "exported" — buildings built outside the Boston area.

It recognizes one of the facts about architecture here: that it's something Boston is known for around the world. Boston architects, not always as busy as they'd like to be at home, are busy and respected from Cairo to farthest Colorado.

This is the second year of the Export Awards, which are sponsored by the Boston Society of Architects. Last year's winners included fine small buildings such as the Design Research building, a renovated townhouse in Philadelphia by Architectural Resources; Rodes Farm vacation homes in Virginia by Brett Donham; Pembroke dorms at Brown by Donlyn Lyndon, and the Miro foundation in Barcelona by Sert, Jackson.

This year's Honor Awards, in contrast, go to three big, nationally prominent buildings:

— Citicorp Center, by Hugh Stubbins and Associates. This is the huge, glowing aluminum, pointy-headed complex on Lexington avenue in New York. It's an innovative combination of office tower, shopping mall, subway entrance and church. "Citicorp Center's contribution to architecture and urban life will be of the same magnitude as that made by Lever House in the '50s and the Seagram Building in the '60s," says the awards jury, probably without any intentional irony.

— Johns-Manville World Headquarters, Colorado, by The Architects Collaborative. The building design was chosen from among nine submitted in an invitational competition in 1973. The thousand-foot-long building, which looked exciting at the time of the competition, looks a little severe as built, at least in photos. Says the jury: "A building of great strength and beauty that truly symbolizes a world headquarters building. The owners are to be congrat-

ulated for sponsoring an invited competition and for constructing the winning solution."

— Eastwood, Roosevelt Island, New York City, by Sert, Jackson and Associates. This is one of several apartment clusters in the "new town" on an East River island. The jury calls it "the best high rise housing in the city," commends the courtyards, arcaded ground-floor shops and floor-through apartment plans.

Besides the three honor awards, there are five citations:

— Housing for the Elderly, Topsfield, Mass., by Johnson, Hotvedt, DiNisco and Associates.

— Digital Equipment Corporation, Salem, N.H., by Symmes, Maini & McKee.

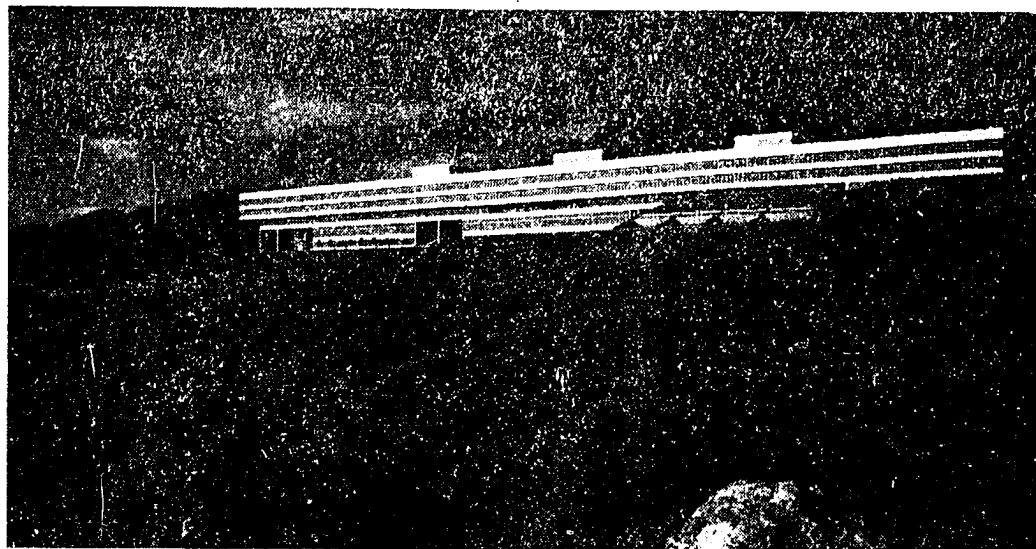
— Swope Center-Marine Biological Labs, Woods Hole, Mass., by Peirce, Pierce and Kramer.

— Fitchburg Wastewater Treatment Plants, Fitchburg, Mass., by Johnson, Hotvedt, DiNisco.

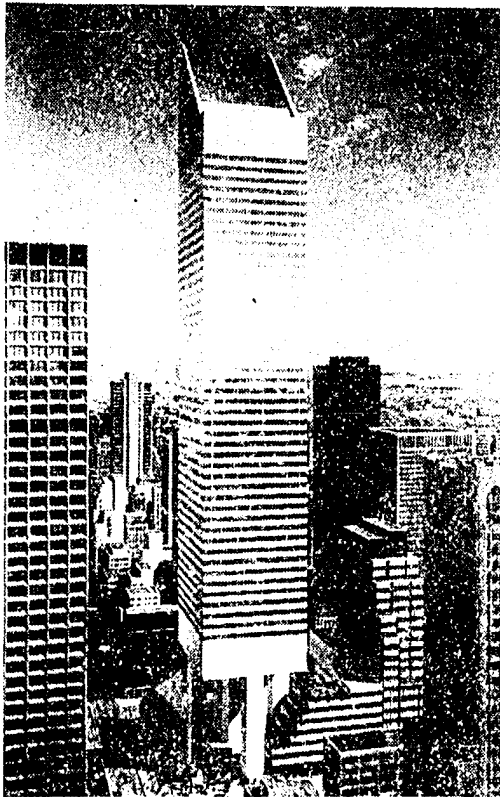
— Hotel Bernardin Enterprise, Piran, Yugoslavia, by The Architects Collaborative.

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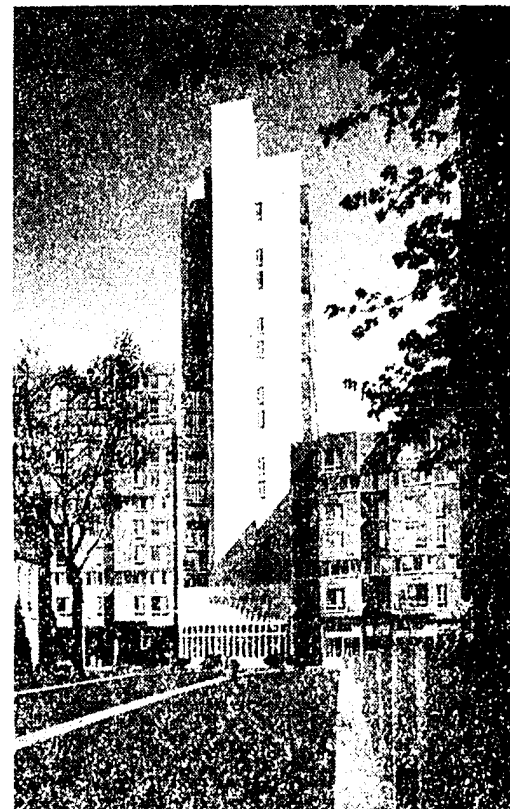
Last week's column was devoted to a discussion of Boston's Combat Zone. I'd forgotten that the City Conservation League has been conducting a survey of the architecture of the Zone and the theater district. It was published, coincidentally, this week in the League's newsletter, "Drumlin," and is an invaluable reference to one of Boston's most interesting districts. Included is a map showing landmark buildings, theaters and other places of historic or architectural value, with a capsule history of each. My only quarrel with this useful investigation is its attack on the proposed state Transportation Building on Stuart street, a sensitive design that will strengthen the whole area. Anyone can get a copy of "Drumlin" by joining the League for \$10 at Box 194, 310 Franklin st., Boston 02210.



Johns-Manville World headquarters in mountains of Colorado is by The Architects Collaborative.



Citicorp Center in New York, by Hugh Stubbins and Associates, is one of three winners of this year's "Boston Export" awards. World's eighth tallest building, it includes offices, a shopping arcade, subway entrance and a church.



Eastwood at Roosevelt Island, New York, is by Sert, Jackson and Associates. Awards jury praised courtyards, arcaded shops and floor-through apartments.